

Task 1

Section A: Markets Analysis and opportunity

- ☐ I would prioritize the Middle East Market for the initial launch. Although the USA is a large and mature market, it is highly saturated with established players, making customer acquisition expensive and differentiation difficult for a new entrant. In contrast, the Middle East Edtech market is projected to grow from around \$11-12 billion to over \$27 billion by 2023. The region has a very young population with nearly 60% under the age of 25, creating massive demand for digital learning and skill presentation. UAE having around 99% internet penetration.
- ☐ The primary target customers in my chosen market will be students, fresh graduates and job seekers whose age ranges 16-30 years. Many learners in this region struggle to complete

traditional online courses due to lack of engagement, low motivation, limited personalized guidance.

☐ The top 3 competitors in my chosen market,

i) Coursera

ii) Udemy

iii) freeCodeCamp

Programming Hero does fill the gaps with gamified learning experience, Story-based, interactive coding approach, AI-powered personalized feedback, strong community and mentor & peer engagements.

☐ The single biggest risk in this market entry is lack of brand trust and awareness in a new market.

~~I do migrate~~ We do mitigate the risk by localizing (Arabic UI, regional content) and build awareness through influencers, community campaigns and coding challenges.

Section B: Go-to-market Strategy

- ☐ Positioning Statement — "Programming Hero is an AI-powered gamified coding platform that helps young learners in the Middle East build real-world tech skills through engaging, habit-forming learning at an affordable price".
- ☐ Top 3 customer acquisition channels are —
 - i) Influencer & creator Marketing: Platforms like Youtube and Tiktok drive fast trust and awareness as Middle Eastern youth heavily rely on creators.
 - ii) Performance Marketing: Targeted ads on Facebook and Instagram enable precise audience reach, quick scaling and strong conversation via retargeting.
 - iii) community & challenges: Gamified coding challenges, leaderboards, peer competition boost engagement and completion — perfectly aligning with programming hero core model.

☐ Hybrid Model because combines fast user growth through direct students (B2C) with scalable, high volume acquisition and credibility via institution (B2B)

☐ Strategic partner with top most universities like 'King Saud University', telecom leaders like 'Etisalat', and regional tech influencers to drive rapid user acquisition, distribution and trust.

Section C: Revenue and Growth Model

☐ I recommend a Freemium and Subscription Hybrid Model. Freemium reduces entry friction in a trust-sensitive market. Subscription ensures predictable recurring revenue.

☐ I assume a conservative 'Edtech' conversion baseline of 1-3% and since this is a gamified AI based platform with higher engagement, I slightly uplift it to 4-5% as traction improves over time.

Suppose, we choose Freemium so the paid conversion rate 4% in 6 months and 5% in 12 months. Average monthly subscription Fee \$8 per user.

period	Total users	Paying users	Monthly Revenue	Annualized
month 6	100,000	4,000	\$32,000	
month 12	400,000	20,000	\$160,000	\$19M

▣ Suppose, paying users = 20,000
price per user = \$8 per month

$$\therefore \text{Monthly Revenue} = 20,000 \times 8 = \$160,000$$

$$\therefore \text{estimated revenue at month 12} = 160,000 \times 12 = \$1,920,000$$

▣ The single metric is Activation to retention rate in 1 week to 4 week, measuring how many users continue actively learning after initial sign up.

Section D : 90-Day Execution Roadmap

1) Day 1 to 30 : Foundation

- i) Build and finalize MVP flow (AI-guided lessons and coding experience)
- ii) Implement Arabic localization and onboarding experience for Middle East users.
- iii) Set up analytics system tracking activation, retention and lesson completion.

2) Days 31 to 60 : Launch

- i) Acquire first 10,000 users via Influencer campaigns on TikTok and Youtube.
- ii) Run paid acquisition campaigns on Instagram and Facebook with A/B tested creatives.
- iii) Launch coding challenges and referral system to drive organic user growth.

3) Days 61 to 90: Optimise

- i) Improve onboarding based on Week-1 drop-off and retention data.
- ii) Scale only the top performing acquisition channel (highest CAC efficiency)
- iii) Optimize free-to-paid conversion funnel through pricing and feature adjustments.

Section E: Assumptions & Risks

Key assumptions are —

- 1) Strong learner demand exists in the Middle East for affordable, skill-based coding education driven by youth unemployment and digital transformation.
- 2) Gamified and AI-powered learning increases retention compared to traditional video-based platforms.
- 3) Freemium model will generate at least 3-5% conversion within 6-12 months.

▣ Scenario 1: Low user retention after signup
users try the platform but do not continue
learning after Week 1.

Response

- 1) Redesign onboarding to make first learning experience faster and more engaging.
- 2) Introduce stronger gamification (streaks, rewards, daily goals)
- 3) Reduce friction in first lesson completion.

Scenario 2: High acquisition cost with weak conversion

Paid ads and influencer campaigns bring users, but they do not convert to paid subscribers.

Response

- 1) Shift focus from paid ads to organic/community driven growth.
- 2) Improve free tier value but delay premium upsell timing.
- 3) Test pricing model (lower entry price or longer free trial).

☐ If budget runs out early with zero revenue

- 1) Immediately stop all paid acquisition channels.
- 2) Pivot to zero-cost growth strategy (organic only)
- 3) Influencer collaborations (Performance based)
- 4) Community driven coding challenges
- 5) Referral-based viral loops
- 6) Focus only on improving product retention, not scaling.
- 7) Delay expansion and focus on achieving product market fit first